

CreArtBox

Chamber music ensemble - New York City - since 2013

BIOGRAPHY · 5298 CHARACTERS

Long biography

CreArtBox creates and produces live art performances, fusing classical and contemporary music with original ideas encouraged by multidisciplinary interaction. Its programs are designed to support professional artists, encourage the creation of new meaningful work, make world-class performances accessible to everyone regardless of background or economic circumstance, inspire and educate future generations, revitalize local communities, and nurture new ways of human expression.

Recognized by *The New Yorker* as one of its "art and music top picks," praised by *Time Out* as "an ensemble devoted to multidisciplinary events," and described by *BroadwayWorld* as "wholly authentic, visually and aurally compelling," CreArtBox is celebrated for its ability to enhance the listening experience of live music through theatrical design while preserving the integrity of each composition.

The organization was founded in New York City in 2013 by flutist *Guillermo Laporta* and pianist *Josefina Urraca*, who continue to serve as its artistic directors, and is now in its 12th season. The project was originally conceived in Europe in 2006 as Cre.Art Project by Laporta and clarinetist and performance creator Tagore González.

With its headquarters in New York City and Asturias, Spain, CreArtBox develops an array of distinctive platforms to pursue its mission: the New York Series at The DiMenna Center for Classical Music, international touring, a printed magazine, a classical music streaming platform, a live music podcast with the Queens Public Library, an open call and commissioning program for composers, and Festival ADAR, which develops the arts in rural Spain.

The kind of performance that most defines its identity can be called a visual concert. Visual art and theatrical design are used to enhance the audience's listening experience of live classical and contemporary music while respecting the original composition, usually in medium-size venues where lights and projections can surround the audience. CreArtBox also plays more traditional chamber music concerts, which have taken the group to Japan, Spain, Europe, Canada, and the east coast of the United States.

The 2026/27 season runs from October to August: four productions at The DiMenna Center, eleven works drawn from the ensemble's open Call for Scores, one world premiere, touring dates in Illinois, Kentucky and the Hudson Valley, a residency at the Kuopio Conservatory in Finland, and the seventh Festival ADAR in Asturias.

CreArtBox has run an open Call for Scores since its first season, alongside a composer residency program, fostering the creation of new works and mentoring emerging voices. Over the past decade it has presented works by Pulitzer Prize winners Caroline Shaw and David Lang and by Timo Andres, Anna Clyne, Nico Muhly, Sebastian Currier, Todd Reynolds, Philip Lasser, Joshua Penman, Andrea Casarrubios, Hannah Selin, Dai Wei, Brian Wysocki, Annamaria Kowalsky, Celeste Oram, JP Jofre, Marcos Fernández, Michael Grebla, Nathan Schram and Cullynn Murphy, among many others.

Composers reaching the current season through the call include Eric Moe, a Guggenheim fellow honoured by the American Academy of Arts and Letters; Zygmund de Somogyi, a Royal Philharmonic Society composer for 2025 and Festival ADAR's composer in residence; Eli Tausen á Lava, nominated for the 2026 Nordic Council Music Prize; and Paul Novak and Sam Wu, both winners of the ASCAP Foundation's Morton Gould Young Composer Award.

Each core member brings a distinctive artistic trajectory: Laporta has combined a career as a flutist with theater directing and lighting design; Urraca is an acclaimed solo and chamber pianist, a pupil of Dmitri Bashkurov; Gendron is a longtime member of the Momenta Quartet and one of the concertmasters of the Orpheus Chamber Orchestra; Cohen is a special prize winner at the Primrose International Viola Competition; and Yang is a founding member of the Naumburg-winning Merz Trio.

Alongside its concert programs, CreArtBox has produced a series of theatrical and interdisciplinary works, including *Architecture of a Common Man* (2023), the opera-ballet *Two Roads* (2019), *Visuality* (2012/14), the opera *Noctum* (2011), the musical *London: The Show* (2009), and *Cre.Art Project I* (2006).

CreArtBox works with visual artists, designers, dancers and other creative minds to craft multi-layered performances centered around classical music, with a roster of musicians that includes members of the Metropolitan Opera Orchestra, the New York Philharmonic, the BBC Orchestra, and the Chamber Music Society of Lincoln Center.

The ensemble has been awarded the Queens Council on the Arts New Work Grant and the New York Foundation for the Arts Fellowship, and is supported by the New York State Council on the Arts, the NYC Department of Cultural Affairs, the Amphion Foundation, the Alice M. Ditson Fund, the Aaron Copland Fund for Music, Spain Arts and Culture, and the Government of Asturias, alongside a group of individual supporters. In addition to its American-based activities, CreArtBox co-produces Festival ADAR, an international arts festival held since 2021 in Asturias, Spain, dedicated to revitalizing rural communities through music, contemporary creation, artist residencies, and site-specific projects.